

Commodities Sentiment Report

2026-07-07 20:05 UTC

Previous edition: 2026-07-07 16:30 UTC. US settlement edition: the Hormuz incident escalated into a confirmed Iranian attack and crude repriced hard into the close.

COMMODITY	SENTIMENT	CROWD	Δ VS LAST	ONE-LINE DRIVER
Crude Oil (WTI/Brent)	0 Neutral / mixed	●○○ 1	▲ from Leaning bearish	Iran attacked a Qatari tanker; Brent settled +3% at \$74.16; US revoked Iran sale authorization
Natural Gas	-2 Bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	Storage math unchanged, but the Hormuz LNG-security tail is growing
Gold	+1 Leaning bullish	●●○ 2	unchanged	Pre-minutes fade persists; Hormuz escalation adds a safe-haven cushion
Silver	+1 Leaning bullish	●●○ 2	unchanged	Weaker into the close with gold; WSB still split 58/42
Copper	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Eased 0.4% to ~\$6.21; structural deficit story unchallenged
Wheat	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	KC/Chicago divergence widens: KC +3.5¢ vs Chicago flat at ~\$6.00
Corn	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Fractionally mixed settle; holding the one-month-high zone
Soybeans	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Mixed complex into Thursday's binary export-sales print

Direction: −3 Very bearish → +3 Very bullish. Crowd: 0 two-sided → 3 crowded & uniform (contrarian risk). Sentiment reflects the tone of current news and trader coverage about the price outlook, not the last price move.

BIGGEST SHIFTS

Crude upgraded to Neutral/mixed (0) — the biggest single-session sentiment move on the board so far. What was "an incident" this morning is now a confirmed **Iranian attack on a Qatari tanker** near Hormuz; Brent settled +3% at \$74.16 and WTI +2.8% at \$70.44, and Washington **revoked an Iran oil-sale authorization**, putting sanctioned barrels back in question. The supply-glut bear case (OPEC+ quotas, Aramco's OSP cut) hasn't gone away — but it's now fully offset by an active-escalation story, and the interim peace agreement looks fragile. That widens the **crude–natgas spread to +2**, its widest reading yet: Henry Hub stays pinned by storage while crude carries the war premium. Everything else held into tomorrow's Fed minutes.

RV pair matrix

Sentiment spread = leg1 – leg2; positive favors leg1 outperformance.

PAIR	SPREAD	Δ VS LAST	READ
gold – silver	0	unchanged	Both +1, crowd 2, fading together pre-minutes; pure event bet
corn – soybeans	+1	unchanged	Holding pattern into Thursday's export sales — that print moves this pair
corn – wheat	0	unchanged	KC-over-Chicago (intra-wheat) still beats this pair as the ag supply expression
crude – natgas	+2	▲ from +1	Widest yet. Crude carries the Iran war premium; gas stays storage-pinned. This is now an explicit escalation trade — de-escalation headlines collapse it
gold – copper	-1	unchanged	Copper's structural story vs gold's parked macro story; Friday's COT is the first positioning check

Catalyst calendar (next 7 days)

DATE	EVENT	LEGS	WHY IT MATTERS NOW
Tue Jul 7 (tonight)	API petroleum inventories (4:30pm ET)	crude	First stocks print with a fresh war premium in the price
Wed Jul 8	FOMC minutes (2pm ET)	gold, silver, copper	The metals gate: both precious legs crowd-2 long-biased going in
Wed Jul 8	EIA Weekly Petroleum Status (10:30am ET)	crude	Build vs draw decides whether \$70+ WTI holds without fresh escalation
Thu Jul 9	EIA natural gas storage (10:30am ET)	natural-gas	Consensus-plus injection entrenches -2
Thu Jul 9	USDA weekly export sales (8:30am ET)	soybeans, corn, wheat	Near-binary for beans: Cofco cargoes vs the MY-low baseline
Thu Jul 9	US Drought Monitor update	wheat, corn	Plains footprint vs 63%-in-drought baseline
Fri Jul 10	CFTC COT + Saxo/Hansen note (3:30pm ET)	all	Wheat short-covering check; crude spec response to the attack week
Fri Jul 10	Kitco Weekly Gold Survey	gold	Consensus check after the minutes
Jul 10-12 window	USDA WASDE	wheat, corn, soybeans	First full balance sheet since the acreage shocks
Mon Jul 13	USDA Crop Progress (4pm ET)	corn, soybeans	Pollination conditions vs the warm 8-14 day outlook

Score history (oldest → newest)

crude-oil		-2 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1 → 0
natural-gas		-1 → -1 → -1 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -2 → -2
gold		+1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1

silver		+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +1 → +1
copper		0 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +2 → +2 → +2
wheat		+2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
corn		+1 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2 → +2
soybeans		-1 → 0 → 0 → 0 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1

Crude Oil (WTI / Brent)

0 Neutral / mixed

●○○ 1

What's happening. *Upgraded from leaning bearish.* Iran attacked a Qatari tanker near the Strait of Hormuz — no longer an unattributed projectile — and the US responded by revoking an Iran oil-sale authorization. Brent settled 3% higher at \$74.16, WTI +2.8% at \$70.44, with the interim peace agreement's durability now openly questioned ([CNBC](#), [OilPrice](#)). The bear stack (OPEC+ quota increases, Aramco's \$11 OSP cut, Trump's pump-price campaign) is unchanged underneath.

Social pulse. Retail oil sentiment is reheating — StockTwits gauges on USO ran "extremely bullish" on "extremely high" volume during Hormuz episodes ([StockTwits](#) — note some circulating posts date from the June \$100 spike; discount accordingly). Crowd moves to 1.

Positioning read. The two-sided market resolved a leg: escalation is now *active*, not residual, and sanctioned Iranian barrels are back in question — that's why 0, not -1. But this is a headline-driven premium sitting on a physically loosening market (OPEC+ barrels arriving next month), so the read is regime-dependent: escalation headlines own the tape short-term, EIA balances own it beyond. Shorts against \$70+ need the peace to hold; tonight's API and tomorrow's EIA are the first fundamental tests.

Natural Gas

-2 Bearish

○○○ 0

What's happening. August gas hovers ~\$3.27; the storage-driven bear case is unchanged (87 Bcf injection, +6.2% vs average, cooler eastern forecasts through Jul 15) ([Investing.com](#), [NGI](#)). The growing caveat: an Iranian attack that hit a *Qatari LNG-linked* vessel is exactly the global-gas security tail flagged in prior editions.

Social pulse. Crowd still leans bullish against the news; no fresh signal.

Positioning read. The -2 stands on domestic storage math, but the LNG tail is fattening — sustained Hormuz attacks lift TTF/JKM and pull US feedgas demand. Henry Hub shorts are increasingly short a global-gas escalation they aren't being paid for. Thursday's injection is the domestic catalyst; Qatari shipping headlines are the tail to watch.

Gold

+1 Leaning bullish

●●○ 2

What's happening. Spot weakened after the equities close as traders faded part of the jobs-led rebound, balancing Wednesday's minutes against Hormuz headlines ([Kitco](#), [Investing.com](#)). Hike odds hold near 50%.

Social pulse. GLD unchanged on WSB: light volume, 80% positive ([ApeWisdom](#)).

Positioning read. Two supports now (rate repricing + war risk) versus one event risk (the minutes). The escalation cushions the downside of a hawkish read — gold's risk/reward into the event improved today even as price softened. Still +1 until the minutes speak.

Silver +1 Leaning bullish ●●○ 2

What's happening. Softer with gold into the close, holding near \$61-62; the momentum stall that drove yesterday's trim persists ([Kitco](#), [Trading Economics](#)).

Social pulse. WSB unchanged: 45 mentions, split 58/42 ([ApeWisdom SLV](#)).

Positioning read. Unchanged from the trim: contested bull case, event tomorrow. Silver gets less safe-haven cushion from Hormuz than gold does — the ratio slightly favors gold on further escalation, another reason gold–silver at 0 resolves with the minutes.

Copper +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Copper eased 0.4% to ~\$6.21 in a quiet session; nothing challenged the structural stack (TC/RC at \$0, concentrate stocks at historic lows, Yangshan premium firming) ([Trading Economics](#), [Kitco](#)).

Social pulse. No change; still no retail crowd (crowd 1).

Positioning read. A drifting price on an intact structural story keeps this the board's preferred uncrowded long. Friday's COT shows whether funds have started building the position; until then the gold–copper spread at -1 remains the expression.

Wheat +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. The intra-wheat divergence widened again: September KC HRW +3.5¢ to \$6.385 while Chicago SRW slipped a quarter-cent to ~\$6.00 — exactly the drought-map split (63% of winter wheat area in drought, HRW-concentrated) ([Farm Progress](#), [Barchart](#)).

Social pulse. Unchanged mood/money split; the extreme managed-money short base is the standing story.

Positioning read. KC-over-Chicago keeps paying and remains the precise expression; Friday's COT is the squeeze check and WASDE (Jul 10-12) the balance-sheet risk. Unchanged +2.

Corn +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Fractionally mixed settle, holding the one-month-high zone; the France-damage and China-framework drivers are intact with the warm 8-14 day Midwest outlook as the swing factor ([Farm Progress](#)).

Social pulse. Still lagging; no retail crowd.

Positioning read. Unchanged; Monday's Crop Progress is the next dated test of the weather premium.

Soybeans +1 Leaning bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Nearby contracts held forward momentum in a mixed complex (meal firm, oil soft) as the market waits on Thursday's export sales against the marketing-year-low baseline ([Farm Progress](#), [Barchart](#)).

Social pulse. No fresh signal; ag legs carry no Reddit presence.

Positioning read. Unchanged and still near-binary on Thursday: Cofco cargoes printing opens the +2 path; an empty week fades the rally. The corn–soybean spread is the vehicle either way.